

The Day the Tablet Slept



A PLAY BEFORE PIXELS READ-ALOUD



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First edition, 2026.

The illustrations were drawn as flat digital art. The text is set in Fredoka, with Bricolage Grotesque and Nunito Sans.

A note for grown-ups: puddle play, cooking and box-building are best enjoyed with a grown-up close by. The tablet in this story is a made-up character and is not based on any real product.

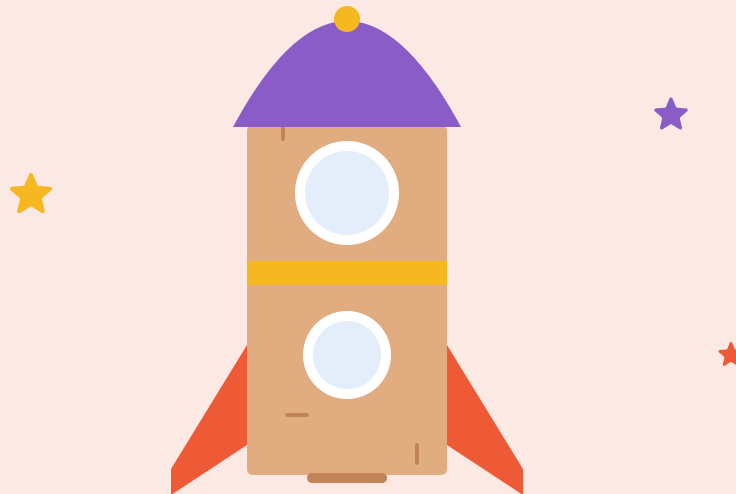
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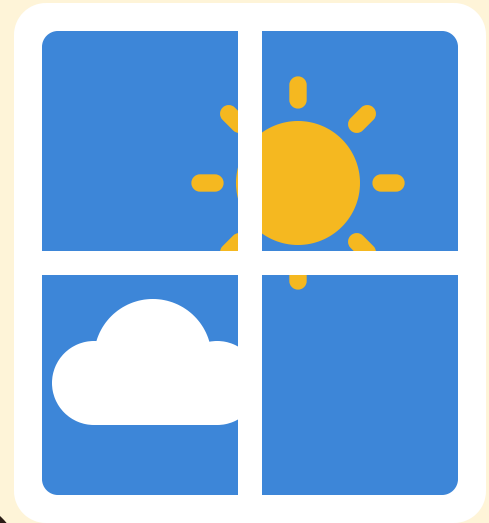
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For every grown-up who ever said, “Let’s
see what we can make,”
and every kid who turned a box into a
rocket.



On Saturday morning, Ada
zoomed downstairs to find the
tablet. Her slippers were on the
wrong feet. She did not care one
bit.



But the tablet was wearing a nightcap. Its eyes were closed. And it was going...

zzz... zzz... zzz.



“The tablet is sleeping,” whispered Papa. “It worked hard all week. Today, it gets to rest.”



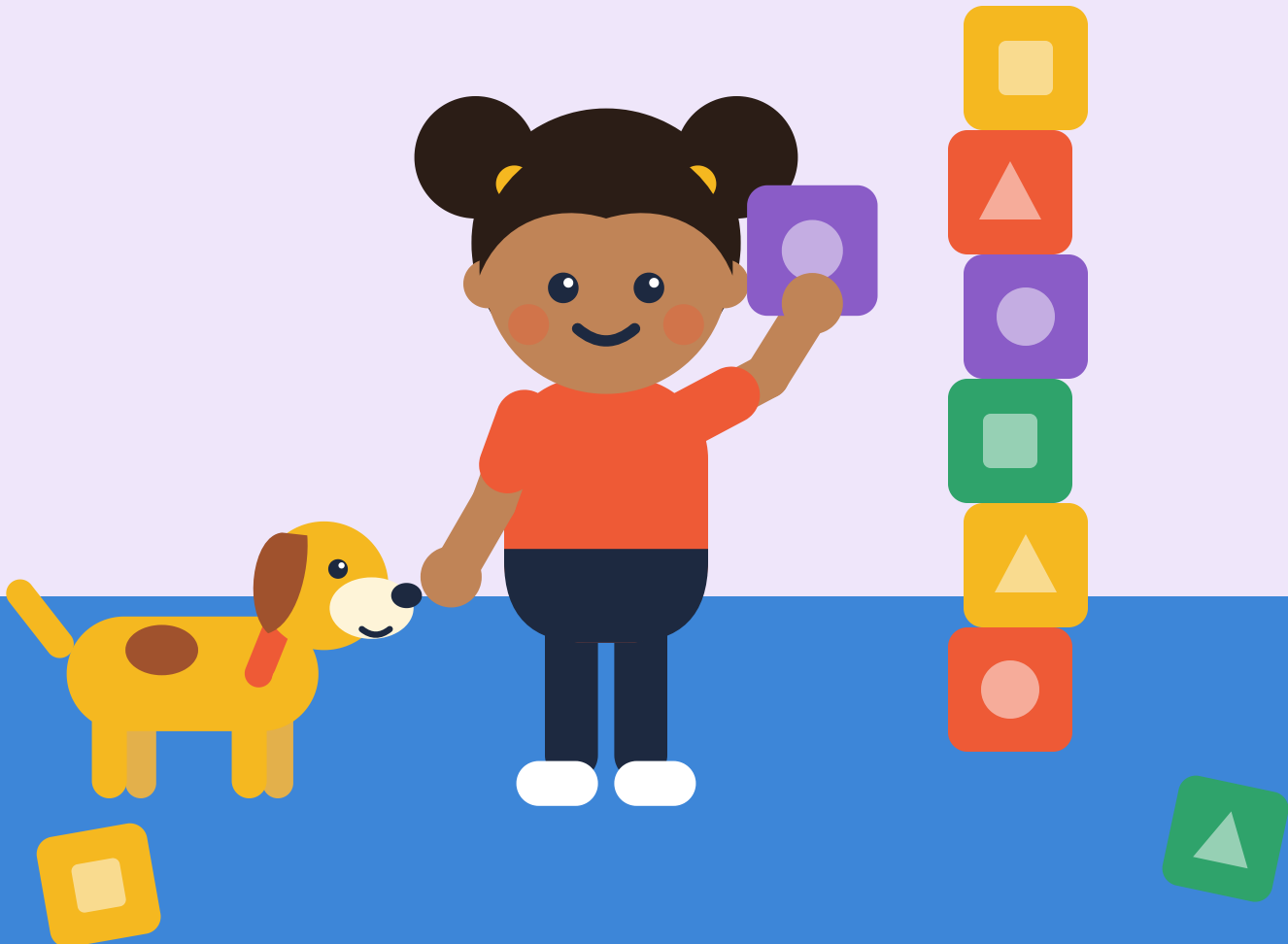
“Sleeping?” said Ada. “In the DAYTIME?”

“Everybody needs a rest sometimes,” said Papa.

Shhh... the tablet is sleeping.
So what shall we do today?



Ada found the blocks. One, two, three... a tower! Four, five, six... taller than Biscuit! Biscuit sat very still and watched.



Seven... eight... **CRASH!** Biscuit jumped. Ada giggled.
“Again!” So they built it again. And again. And AGAIN.



Outside, last night's rain had left puddles everywhere – big ones, small ones, and one with a real duck in it! Ada pulled on her yellow boots.

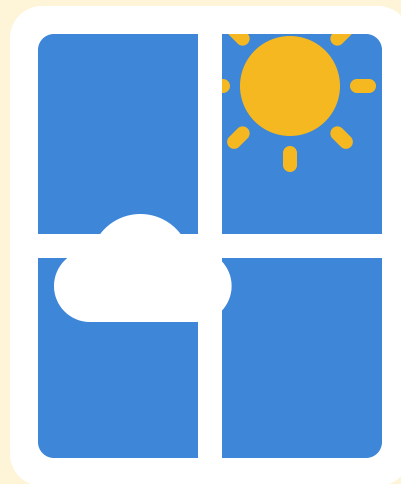


SPLISH went the small one. **SPLASH** went the middle one.
SPLOOOSH went the great big one – all over Papa's shoes!
“Oops,” said Ada. “Oops,” said Papa... and jumped in, too.



Back inside, Ada peeled off her wet
boots and tiptoed to the shelf.

Tip... tip... tip...



tip

tip



The tablet was still sleeping. It snored a teeny-tiny snore: zzz-bip... zzz-bip...

Shhh... the tablet is sleeping.
So what shall we do now?



In the hall sat a big, empty box.

“That’s not a box,” said Ada. “That’s a **ROCKET!**”

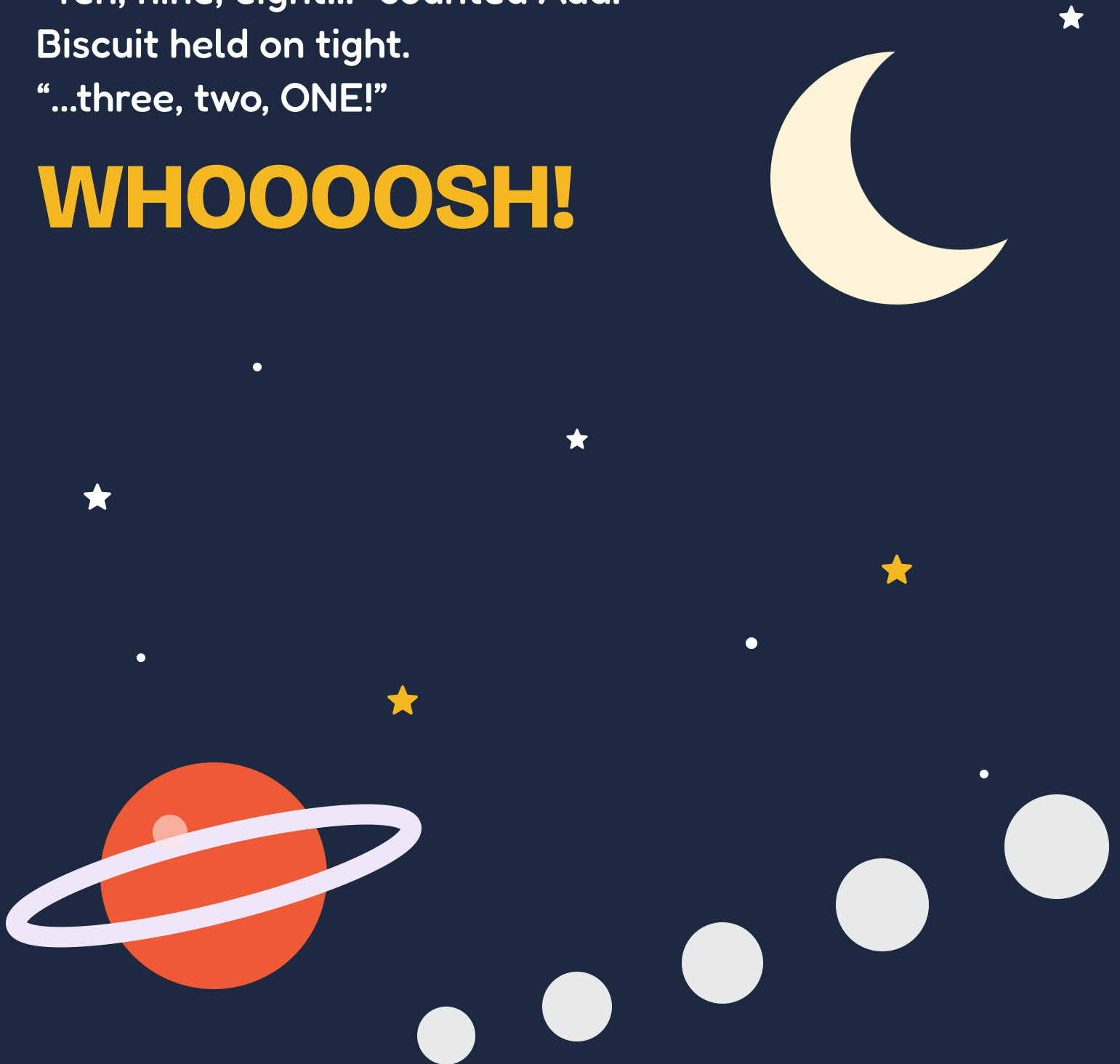


She gave it round windows. She gave it red wings. She gave it a pointy top — just like the tablet's nightcap.



“Ten, nine, eight...” counted Ada.
Biscuit held on tight.
“...three, two, ONE!”

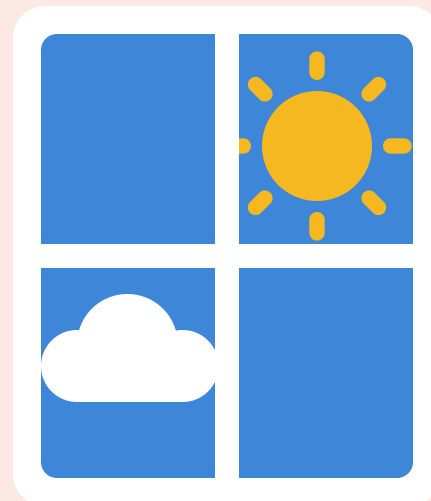
WHOOOOOSH!



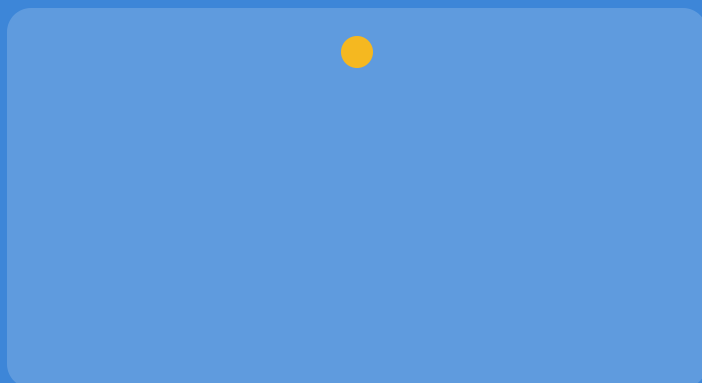
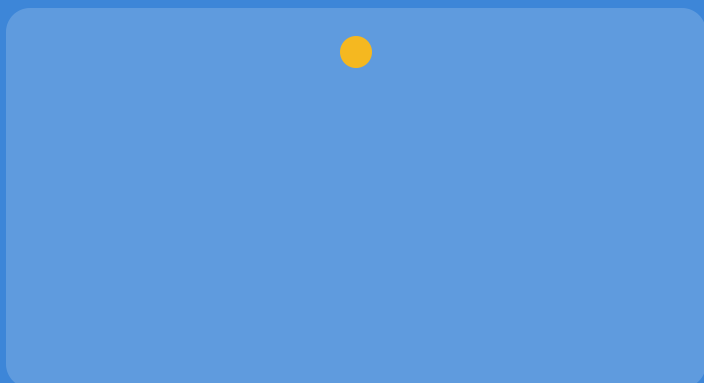
Past the moon. Past the stars. Past a planet
made entirely of socks. Biscuit was the
co-pilot. He was very good at barking at
comets.



All that flying made Ada hungry.
Her tummy rumbled like a rocket.
“Pancakes?” asked Papa.
“**PANCAKES!**” said Ada.



Ada cracked the egg (mostly into the bowl). She stirred and stirred. Papa flipped. **Flip! Flop! Plop!**
“That one looks like the moon,” said Ada.



After lunch, Ada peeked at the shelf. The tablet had rolled over, and its nightcap had flopped. But it was still sleeping.



Shhh... the tablet is sleeping.
So what shall we do now?

“Let’s go find some stories,” said Papa.



The library had books about dinosaurs, books about rockets, books about the moon, and one book about a dog in boots.



“Shhh,” whispered Ms. Rosa the librarian. “Books like it quiet.”

“Just like the tablet!” whispered Ada. She picked a book about a bear who could not sleep.



That night, Papa read the bear book. Ada turned the pages. She did all the growly bear voices.

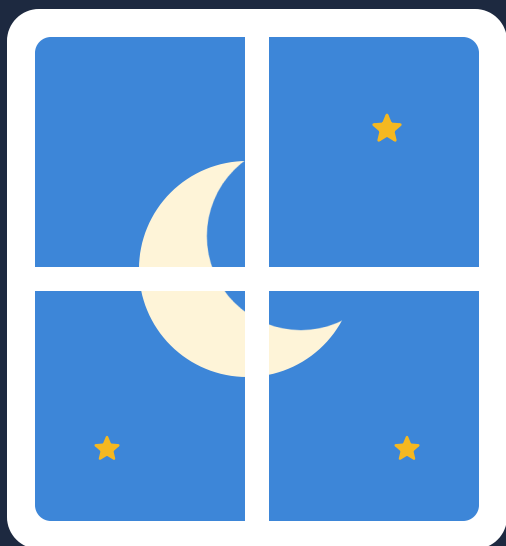
GRRR... YAWWWN.



“What was your favorite part of today?” asked Papa. Ada thought and thought. “The crash. The splash. The rocket. The pancakes. The library...” She yawned a big bear yawn. “All of it.”



Down the hall, in its cozy nightcap, the tablet slept. It had rested all day long, and it was dreaming a quiet, happy dream.



And snug in her bed, Ada slept too.

Shhh... everybody is sleeping.
What a good, good day.



Talk about it

For grown-ups: after reading, try a few of these. Pause, wait, and let your child answer. There are no wrong answers.



- 1 Why do you think the tablet needed a rest? When do *you* like to rest?
- 2 Ada did lots of things on her day. Which one would you like to try first?
- 3 What could a big box turn into at our house?
- 4 What should we cook together? What will your job be?
- 5 Can you find Biscuit on every page? What is he doing?
- 6 Let's plan our own "tablet sleeps" day. Pick three things to do!

Read it again, and... say what you see ("Biscuit is jumping!"), repeat and add one word ("Splash!" → "Big splash!"), and follow your child's lead. Puddles, cooking and box-building are best with a grown-up close by.



In the morning, the tablet woke up and stretched. “Good morning!” said Ada. “Wait till I tell you about my day...”



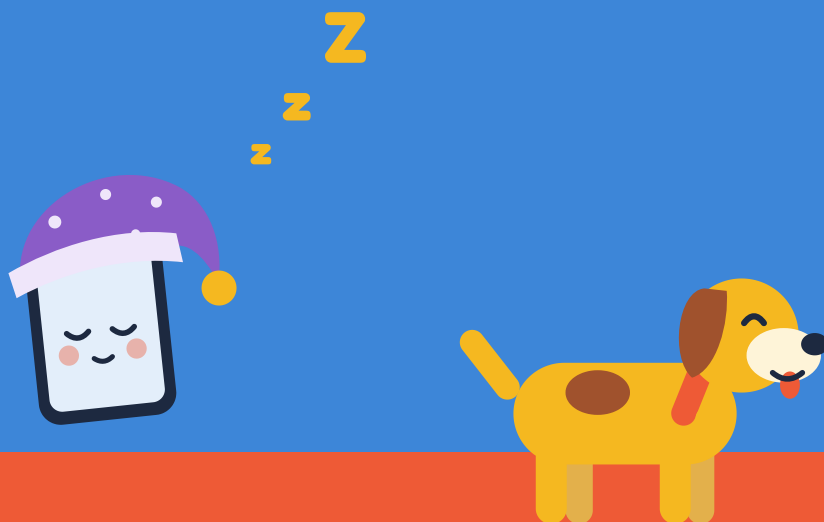
The End

Shhh... the tablet is sleeping. So what shall we do today?



Ada's tablet is taking a day off — nightcap and all. So Ada builds a tower (CRASH!), splashes every puddle, blasts off in a cardboard-box rocket, flips pancakes with Papa and finds the perfect library book.

A warm, funny read-aloud about a day full of play, and a tablet that simply needed a good rest. Includes “Talk about it” questions for grown-ups.



AGES 3-7 · PLAY BEFORE PIXELS

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2 × 1.2 in · keep clear